

How to Play Hextraction

You'll need:

- A game board
- Enough tiles to fill the game board
- Rules cards for every effect tile
- Some 10mm steel balls (or 3/8")

Each opponent needs:

- At least three more tiles for a starting hand
- A good sense of humor

Each player can add any number of their own tiles to the pool. Make sure to sign them so you can get them back!

Game Setup

Each player secretly picks three of their tiles to be their starting hand. Shuffle the rest together into the shared pool. Any player who didn't bring tiles draws three at random.

💡 *Yes, you share all game tiles. Don't get too attached to them.*

Decide who goes first. I recommend reverse alphabetical order by first name.

💡 *Taking Hextraction seriously is a BAD IDEA. It is a silly game.*

Play proceeds to the right.

Take a Turn

Each turn, you must:

- Roll a ball
- Play a tile

You can do these in any order, but you must do both each turn.

To roll a ball, pick a ramp and drop a ball all up in there. Wait for all balls and tiles to come to rest.

If any effect tiles get hit (the ones with stars), check if any effects have activated. The active player decides which order to apply them.

Then, if a ball:

- **Never leaves the ramp:** Roll on another ramp. If it's being blocked by a tile with no ways in, destroy that tile.
- **Falls through an empty slot, or a hole in a tile:** Nothing happens.
- **Crosses a finish line:** YOU WIN! Winner winner chicken dinner.
- **Leaves the board any other way:** Destroy the last tile the ball touched.
- **Gets stuck on a tile:** Leave it. Then, if at least two more balls are also touching that tile, destroy ANY tile ANY of those balls are touching.

💡 *Zoomers: The chicken dinner thing is an outdated video-game reference.*

If your ball, or an effect, causes other balls to start rolling, it counts as if you rolled those balls yourself. Balls have no effect any other time.

To play a tile, take a tile from your hand and drop it into an open slot. The tile should "bottom out" with gravity alone - you don't need to click it in.

If the tile has moving parts, you can adjust them before or immediately after playing the tile. **Do not touch tiles except to play, destroy, or perform an effect!** If a mechanism doesn't work, c'est la vie.

💡 *Some tiles have a notch that limits which orientations they can be placed in. If the tile doesn't "bottom out," don't force it- try rotating it.*

If there are no valid open slots for a tile, you can Overwrite an installed tile to make room. To overwrite, destroy a tile on the board and play one in that slot.

Effect Tiles

If a tile has a star, ask its owner for its rules card! Here are some common kinds of effects:

Triggers activate when a ball touches the trigger area, marked with triangles or zig-zags, during a roll. After the rolling balls come to a stop, apply every trigger you hit in any order. If the effect says "this ball," it only activates if the ball is still in the trigger area.

Limits affect where you can play a tile. If every compatible slot is full, you can destroy one to make room, just like if the board is full.

On Play effects activate when you play the tile, as soon as your fingers release it.

Combos are two or more tiles nested together. To play one, split them apart and play both at once. If either part leaves the board, also remove its counterpart and reassemble the Combo. You don't need to remember which halves were originally connected - just grab any corresponding tile owned by the same player.

Virtual tiles live in a separate Virtual Pool. You're only allowed to draw or play tiles from the Virtual Pool by using an effect with the word 'Create.' When a Virtual tile leaves the board, put it in the Virtual Pool.

Voting On Tiles

If you think a tile is unfair, you can call a vote to destroy it.

All players must vote - no abstaining allowed. If you win or tie, destroy the tile and immediately end its effects. If the tile was being played as the vote was called, the active player can draw a replacement and play another tile.

Please don't use voting to filibuster games! Use it responsibly.

Tiles with Forbidden effects have a special vote. As you play one, vote on whether to enable the Forbidden effect. If ANY player votes nay, the effect is disabled as long as that tile is on the board.

Ending the Game

After all balls and tiles come to rest, and all effects resolve, a player wins if their ball is in the end zone. It doesn't have to roll through every slot along the way, so stunt ramps are OK! If the ball fell through an open slot and bounced into the end zone, it doesn't count.

If any player wants to leave at any point, they can immediately end the game in a draw so they can reclaim their pieces.